🏪 Salon Onboarding — Full Specification

Developer-Ready Functional Specification (Markdown)

Scope: Account Creation, Business Setup, Payment Setup, Services, Staff, Policies, Marketplace, Verification, Edge Cases

---

1. Overview

The Salon Onboarding flow is the process through which a salon:

- Creates an account
- Sets up business details
- Configures payment processing (Stripe Connect)
- Adds services and pricing
- Adds staff (if applicable)
- Sets cancellation/deposit rules
- Sets availability
- Configures marketplace visibility
- Completes verification steps
- Becomes fully operational on the platform

The onboarding must be:

- Fast (5–10 minutes)
- Mobile-first
- Modular (salon can skip steps and return later)
- Clear and non-technical
- Designed to reduce friction

---

2. Onboarding Entry Points

Salons can start onboarding via:

- “Create Salon Account” button
- Invitation link (from platform or referral)
- Marketplace “Claim this salon” link
- Mobile app onboarding
- Web onboarding

All entry points lead to the same onboarding flow.

---

3. Onboarding Steps (High-Level)

1. **Account Creation**

2. **Business Profile Setup**
3. **Payment Setup (Stripe Connect)**
4. **Service Setup**
5. **Staff Setup** (optional for solo providers)
6. **Policies Setup (Deposits, Cancellation Fees)**
7. **Availability Setup**
8. **Marketplace Visibility Setup**
9. **Verification & Launch**

Each step is detailed below.

---

4. Step-by-Step Onboarding Flow

4.1 Step 1 — Account Creation

Required fields:

- Owner name
- Email
- Phone number
- Password

Optional:

- Referral code
- Social login (Apple/Google)

Flow:

1. Salon enters email + password
2. Email verification sent
3. After verification → proceed to business setup

Edge cases:

- Email already exists → login prompt
- Unverified email → resend verification
- Social login mismatch → merge accounts

4.2 Step 2 — Business Profile Setup

Required fields:

- Business name
- Business category (hair, nails, lashes, brows, esthetics, massage, etc.)
- Address (for map + marketplace)

- Phone number
- Time zone

Optional:

- Logo
- Cover photo
- Bio / About section
- Website
- Instagram / TikTok links

Flow:

1. Salon enters basic info
2. System validates address
3. System sets default time zone
4. Salon preview of public profile

Edge cases:

- Home-based salons → option to hide exact address
- Multi-location → option to add additional locations later

4.3 Step 3 — Payment Setup (Stripe Connect)

Required fields (Stripe handles):

- Legal business name
- Owner name
- Bank account
- Tax information
- Identity verification

Flow:

1. Salon clicks “Set up payments”
2. Redirect to Stripe Connect onboarding
3. Stripe detects:
    - Existing Stripe account → salon logs in
    - No account → new connected account created
4. Stripe returns success token
5. Platform marks payment setup as “Complete”

What salon sees:

- “You will receive payouts automatically”
- “Your clients can now pay deposits and fees”

Edge cases:

- Verification pending → allow bookings but hold payouts
- Verification failed → disable payments until resolved
- Salon skips payment setup → allow booking but no deposits

4.4 Step 4 — Service Setup

Required fields:

- Service name
- Duration
- Price

Optional:

- Category (hair, nails, etc.)
- Add-ons
- Variants (short hair / long hair, etc.)
- Description
- Photos
- Staff assignment
- Deposit override
- Prepayment requirement

Flow:

1. Salon selects templates (optional)
2. Adds services manually or imports from:
    - CSV
    - Another platform (future)
3. System validates duration + price
4. Services appear in booking flow

Edge cases:

- No services added → cannot go live
- Missing prices → mark as “price on consultation”

4.5 Step 5 — Staff Setup (Optional for solo providers)

Required fields:

- Staff name
- Role

Optional:

- Photo
- Bio

- Working hours
- Services they perform
- Commission settings
- Login access (email + password)

Flow:

1. Salon adds staff
2. Assigns services
3. Sets availability
4. Sends staff login invites

Edge cases:

- Solo provider → skip staff step
- Staff without login → can still be assigned services

4.6 Step 6 — Policies Setup

Policies include:

- **Deposits**
- **Cancellation fees**
- **No-show fees**
- **Late arrival rules**
- **Refund rules**

Deposit options:

- Flat amount
- Percentage
- Per-service override
- New clients only

Cancellation fee options:

- Flat amount
- Percentage
- Applies:
    - X hours before appointment
    - No-show
    - Late cancellation

Flow:

1. Salon selects deposit rules
2. Selects cancellation rules
3. System previews how clients will see policies
4. Policies saved

Edge cases:

- Salon disables deposits → booking allowed but no protection
- Salon sets 0% cancellation fee → no fee charged

4.7 Step 7 — Availability Setup

Required fields:

- Business hours

Optional:

- Staff hours
- Breaks
- Holidays
- Blackout dates
- Buffer times

Flow:

1. Salon sets weekly schedule
2. Staff schedules override business hours
3. System validates overlapping times
4. Availability goes live

Edge cases:

- No availability → booking disabled
- Staff availability missing → staff hidden from booking

4.8 Step 8 — Marketplace Visibility Setup

Options:

- Visible in marketplace (default)
- Visible only via direct link
- Hidden from marketplace

Salon can configure:

- Profile visibility
- Post visibility
- Style tags
- Featured services
- Price visibility

Flow:

1. Salon chooses visibility level
2. System previews marketplace profile
3. Salon confirms

Edge cases:

- Hidden salon → still bookable via direct link
- No posts → profile shows services only

4.9 Step 9 — Verification & Launch

Checklist:

- Business profile complete
- Payment setup complete
- At least 1 service
- Availability set
- Policies set

Flow:

1. System checks all required steps
2. If complete → "Your salon is live!"
3. Salon receives:
    - Public booking link
    - QR code
    - Social media sharing buttons

Optional:

- Import clients
- Import appointments
- Add gallery photos
- Create first marketplace post

---

5. Post-Onboarding Experience

After onboarding, salon enters the **Dashboard**, which includes:

- Calendar
- Appointments
- Payments & payouts
- Clients
- Services
- Staff
- Marketplace analytics
- Settings

6. Edge Cases & Special Scenarios

6.1 Salon Skips Payment Setup

- Bookings allowed
- Deposits disabled
- Cancellation fees disabled
- Banner shown: “Set up payments to enable deposits and fees”

6.2 Salon Has Pending Stripe Verification

- Bookings allowed
- Deposits allowed
- Payouts paused until verification completes

6.3 Multi-Location Salons

- Onboarding applies per location
- Shared staff optional
- Shared services optional

6.4 Staff Without Login

- Can be assigned services
- Cannot manage calendar
- Cannot receive notifications

6.5 Incomplete Onboarding

- Dashboard shows progress bar
- Critical steps highlighted
- Booking disabled until required steps complete

7. Non-Functional Requirements

- Onboarding must be mobile-first
- Steps must be skippable (except required ones)
- Autosave after each field
- Clear error messages
- Progress indicator visible at all times
- Onboarding must complete in < 10 minutes

✔ Salon Onboarding Feature Spec Complete